



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Brilla Caritas Elementary

School Website: <https://brillaschools.org/our-schools/brilla-caritas/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) or the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Classicality Audit: Bishop Louis Reicher Catholic School (Waco, TX)

Website used for audit: <https://bishopreicher.com>

Executive Summary

Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Bishop Louis Reicher Catholic School (BLR) presents a distinctly Catholic identity with robust liturgical life (weekly Mass, Eucharist, regular prayer) and explicit virtue formation grounded in St. Thomas Aquinas. Curriculum pages indicate classical elements such as "classical literature," Latin, integrated humanities, and a four-year theology sequence. However, the site does not explicitly commit to the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), nor does it advertise classical pedagogies like Socratic seminar, chanting/recitation, or rhetoric orations. Several pages foreground contemporary college-prep outcomes, AP coursework, and hands-on STEM/technology, which dilute a fully classical orientation. In sum, BLR blends Catholic college-prep with some classical features.

Key strengths - Liturgical life and theological integration (Mass, Eucharist, prayer; catechesis) are strong and prominent, aligning closely with classical Catholic foundations. - Virtue formation is explicit and Aquinas-based; "saints and scholars" purpose appears repeatedly. - Curriculum shows "classical literature," Latin, great authors (Homer, Sophocles, Shakespeare), and a four-year theology sequence, with an "interconnected humanities" emphasis.

Primary gaps - No public articulation of the Trivium/Quadrivium, nor visible Socratic/seminar/recitation/chant practices. - Strong emphasis on robotics, Google Classroom, "21st century" tech skills, PSAT/AP framing—language that maps to negative indicators in the classical lexicon when it eclipses formation and wonder.

Six Elements benchmark used - Positive/negative keyword indicators and category definitions taken from the "Six Essential Elements of a Classical School" keyword framework and the supporting lexicon (e.g., truth, goodness, beauty; Socratic, scholé, chanting; vs. 21st-century skills, project-based dominance, college-and-career emphasis).

CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS — CLASSICAL

1) School keywords observed

- "Weekly Mass," "Eucharist," "daily prayer," "Gospel values" (Middle School)
- "Scripture, liturgy, and prayer... Atrium is a sacred space" (CGS)
- "Education in Virtue... faith, hope, charity; prudence, justice, fortitude, temperance... Christ-centered life" (Virtues Program)

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- “Rigorous academic program grounded in the Catholic liberal arts... love for what is true, good, and beautiful... Weekly All-School Masses; Adoration and Confession” (Overview page excerpts)
 - “Pre-K... helps each child grow in what is true, good, and beautiful... rooted in wonder” (Preschool)

2) Match to Six Elements lexicon

- Positive: theology; sacred scripture; catechesis; liturgy; Mass; Eucharist; prayer; virtue; truth, goodness, beauty (TGB) .
- Negative: none detected (e.g., values-neutral, secular humanism) .

3) Quantification

- Positive hits: 15 (Mass, Eucharist, liturgy, prayer, Scripture, virtue, theological and cardinal virtues, TGB, Christ-centered, CGS, etc.)
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Coverage of sub-elements: 1.00 (transcendental moral realism; grounded in theology; liturgical practices all present)

4) Category score

- CLASSICAL (strong, explicit evidence)
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CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

1) School keywords observed

- “Form students into virtuous disciples of Christ” (Virtues Program)
- “Forming saints and scholars” (Preschool; Visit)
- “Grow in what is true, good, and beautiful... rooted in wonder” (Preschool)
- “College-prep... PSAT... AP Calculus” (High School)
- “Prepare for the 21st century... tech skills” (Technology)

2) Match to Six Elements lexicon

- Positive: formation/virtue; pursuit of truth, goodness, beauty; wonder (scholé orientation) .
- Negative: college and career focus; 21st-century skills/technology emphasis (if dominant) .

3) Quantification

- Positive hits: 7 (virtue/formation; saints and scholars; TGB; wonder)
- Negative hits: 6 (college-prep, PSAT, AP Calculus, “21st century,” tech skills emphasis)
- Percent positive: 0.54
- Coverage of sub-elements: 1.00 (virtue/wisdom aim; formation; TGB affirmed)

4) Category score

- SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (mission-level language is classical; outcome framing leans modern)
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CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

1) School keywords observed

- “Classical literature,” “Latin,” “daily prayer” (Middle School)
- “Four-year theology program... sacred scripture... classic literature... Homer, Sophocles, Shakespeare, Dickens, Austen” (High School)

- “Robust and interconnected humanities... integrated literature and writing; ancient cultures to present” (Humanities)
- “Catholic liberal arts tradition... classical learning... love for what is true, good, and beautiful” (Overview excerpts)
- Robotics program with “hands-on... projects... competitions... STEM fields” (Robotics)
- Technology program with Google Classroom; “21st century” skills (Technology)

2) Match to Six Elements lexicon

- Positive: Great Books/authors; Latin; theology; integrated/harmony of subjects; history (vs. “social studies”).
- Negative: STEM-first or project-based dominance; tech-skills emphasis when primary.

3) Quantification

- Positive hits: 9 (Latin; Great Books/authors; integrated humanities; history; theology; liberal arts language; TGB)
- Negative hits: 3 (robotics/project-based/STEM; 21st-century/tech-skills framing)
- Percent positive: 0.75
- Coverage of sub-elements: 0.75 (Great Books/history/integration—yes; Trivium/Quadrivium explicitly—no)

4) Category score

- SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (classics/Latin/theology present; Trivium not explicit; visible STEM/tech strand)

CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY / TEACHING METHODS — NOT CLASSICAL

1) School keywords observed

- “Rooted in wonder” (Preschool)
- CGS “Scripture, liturgy, prayer... Atrium... sacred space” (contemplative, liturgical pedagogy)
- Robotics as “hands-on... projects... competitions” (experiential focus)
- Technology page: Google Classroom, presentations, 21st-century tech-skills emphasis (skills/efficiency)

2) Match to Six Elements lexicon

- Positive: wonder, contemplation (scholé-oriented lower school).
- Negative: project-based/experiential as dominant; college-prep/efficiency language; absence of Socratic, chanting/recitation, rhetoric orations.

3) Quantification

- Positive hits: 2 (wonder; contemplative liturgical practice in CGS)
- Negative hits: 4 (project-based robotics; presentations/tech-skills/21st century; efficiency framing)
- Percent positive: 0.33
- Coverage of sub-elements: 0.20 (1 of 5: some evidence for contemplative/wonder; no public evidence of chanting/recitation, Socratic/seminar, or rhetoric orations)

4) Category score

- NOT CLASSICAL
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CATEGORY 5: SCHOOL FACULTY — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (limited evidence)

1) School keywords observed

- “In partnership with the Dominican Sisters of Mary, Mother of the Eucharist... rich spiritual environment” (suggests teachers as spiritual models)
- “Caring teachers... dedicated faculty” (general phrasing on visit/overview pages)

2) Match to Six Elements lexicon

- Positive: teachers as models of virtue/mentors; moral imagination; wisdom-centered teaching (implied via partnership with religious order) .
- Negative: None explicit (no “facilitator/guide-on-the-side” language).

3) Quantification

- Positive hits: 2 (religious-order partnership; caring/dedicated faculty)
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Coverage of sub-elements: 0.33 (no published “portrait of a teacher,” faculty collegium/formation, or explicit mentoring language)

4) Category score

- SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (inference from religious-order partnership; otherwise minimal)
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CATEGORY 6: SCHOOL PARENTS & COMMUNITY — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

1) School keywords observed

- “We cherish the partnership between home and school... family-centered community” (Preschool)
- Visit/Open House: invitations to meet faculty/families; “forms saints, scholars, leaders... what is good, true, and beautiful” (Visit/Open House)
- Virtues Program: “We partner with families to form students into virtuous disciples”

2) Match to Six Elements lexicon

- Positive: partnership with parents; parent engagement; community gathered around classical/faith aims .
- Negative: none explicit (no “parent as customer only”).

3) Quantification

- Positive hits: 4
- Negative hits: 0
- Percent positive: 1.00
- Coverage of sub-elements: 0.67 (partnership emphasized; no visible parent formation/book groups; no “visit any time” policy stated)

4) Category score

- SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
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Aggregate Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Strong marks in Element 1 (Religious/Metaphysical) and solid classical signals in Element 3 (Curriculum) are offset by the absence of explicit classical pedagogy (Element 4), a modest/implicit faculty for-

mation posture (Element 5), and mixed goal□framing with modern prep language (Element 2). Parent partnership is present but could be further developed (Element 6). Overall: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, with clear potential to grow into CLASSICAL by clarifying pedagogy and the Trivium and foregrounding formation over outcomes in public materials.

What would move the needle

- Declare the Trivium/Quadrivium publicly: add pages that name grammar, logic, and rhetoric as the “tools of learning,” and show where they live in the curriculum K□12 (logic course in grades 7–9; rhetoric with speeches and orations in high school) .
 - Publish pedagogy: state use of Socratic seminar, disputation, narration/recitation, chanting/memory (especially K–6), and capstone rhetoric orations in grades 11–12 .
 - Make “restful learning” and wonder explicit schoolwide (not only preschool): reference scholé, contemplation, depth over breadth (multum non multa) in academics pages and schedules .
 - Reframe tech/STEM pages: cast robotics/technology as handmaids to liberal learning and rhetoric (e.g., demonstrations that “delight and instruct”) rather than primarily 21st□century skill acquisition; reduce project□based jargon .
 - Faculty formation: post a “Portrait of a Teacher” and “Faculty of Friends” note; mention regular faculty colloquia/seminars in Great Books/classical pedagogy .
 - Parent formation: add parent book studies or “What is Classical Education?” sessions; share reading lists and recorded talks on TGB, Trivium, scholé, and virtue cultivation .
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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